

INDIA'S ROAD TO REDEMPTION RUNS THROUGH THE BOWLING CREASE

No Shami. Limited Bumrah. A raw **pace pack.** Yet India's hopes in England rest on one simple truth — bowl better, win more.

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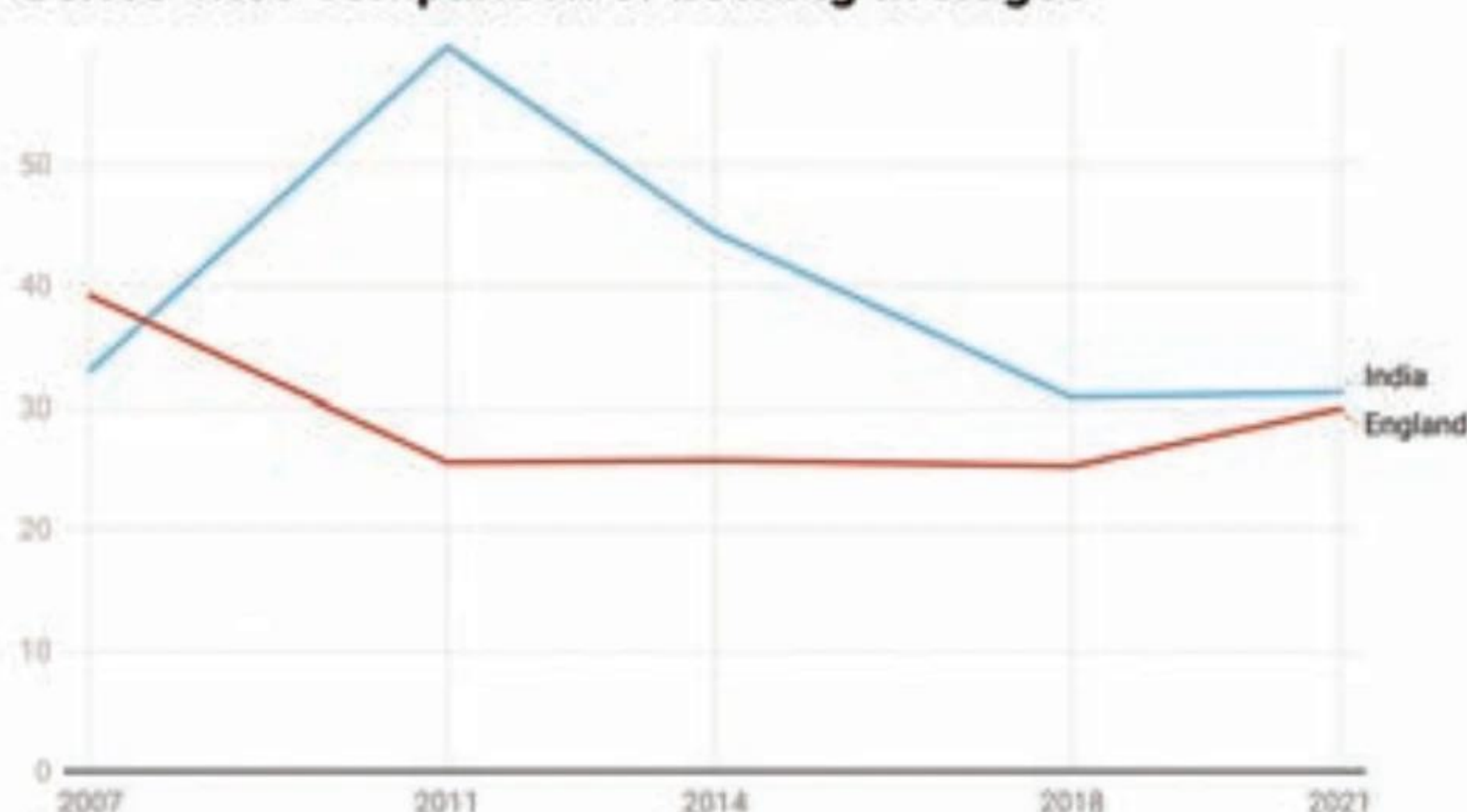
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The formula of India's recent resurgence in Tests overseas is simple — bowl better than your opposition. As India kickstarts its next World Test Championship (WTC) cycle with a five-match series in England under newly appointed skipper Shubman Gill, the adage rings truer than ever.

Over three English summers in the 2010s, the Indians failed abjectly in this endeavour, with the gulf between the two attacks widening. **India finally closed the gap during the tour of 2021, drawing the five-match series 2-2, and Jasprit Bumrah was the point of difference.**

Bumrah's bowling average of 26.27 is the best for any Indian bowler who has played at least five Tests in

Series-wise comparison of bowling averages



India and England both understand that Jasprit Bumrah — rare, unrelenting, and in peak form — could shape the course of this high-stakes series.

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England, and he will do the heavy lifting again.

On the tour of 2021, he led the wickets chart with 21 scalps at an average of 22.47, and left India's second-best bowler — Mohammed Siraj, who averaged 33 for his 18 wickets — far behind in terms of control and discipline. That difference in quality and incisiveness vis-à-vis his peers, and not so much the opposition, is a chink the visitor will want to address.

With resources and experience in short supply, the task will be doubly hard. Bumrah can only feature in